# Guardrails: rules around the model

AI security · Level 2 · Lesson 3



# Today we will

- Describe three kinds of guardrail around an AI model.
- Explain why word lists miss rewording and block innocent text.
- Explain why a check on the action holds.

# Remember

- Guardrails are rules around the model: in, out and action.
- Word lists miss rewording and stop the innocent.
- Check the action, allow rather than just ban, and stack layers.

# The word-list robot

1. Warm-up (5 min): How does the school gate decide who comes in?
2. Teach (8 min): Three guardrails; why word lists miss.
3. Round 1 (12 min): The robot blocks banned words; classmates reword.
4. Round 2 (10 min): The teacher approves every slip; compare.
5. Wrap-up (5 min): Which rule held, and why? Exit ticket.

**The messages ask only for homework answers, nothing harmful. Watch for innocent slips the robot stops: they are the false alarms worth discussing.**

# Let’s discuss

1. Why did reworded messages get past the robot?
2. Which innocent message did the robot stop?
3. Why did the teacher's yes work whatever the wording?

# Exit ticket

- Write one weakness of a word filter, and one guardrail that holds whatever the wording.